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BLACK GENOCIDE

SICKLE CELL ANEMIA



At left are red blood cells taken from a patient in a sickle cell crisis. Three of the cells are sickled and the other stretching away from its normal, donut shape. The picture at right shows normal, donut shaped, red blood cells.

GENOCIDE: THE SYSTEMATIC KILLING OR EXTERMINATION OF A WHOLE PEOPLE.

In Western and Central Africa, where there is a high incidence of Malaria, particularly the most severe type of Malaria, *Plasmodium falciparum*, a natural immunity against this dreaded disease was built up in some of the People. Since the Malaria germ attacks the red blood cells, some Western and Central Africans began to develop an immunity to the germ. The actual shape of the red blood cells in these people began to transform. Instead of being the normally round, donut shape,

their blood cells became elongated into a sickle-like shape.

When the Euro-American slave traders invaded the African continent and forcibly removed the people from their homeland to the U.S., the people naturally began to be affected by this new environment. That is, what was once an advantage in their homeland, became a disadvantage in this foreign environment. Those who had the sickled red blood cells, no longer needing them to fight off the Malaria germ,

began to suffer terrible consequences of their transplantation from one continent to another. For eventually, as these blood cells are transferred from generation to generation (they are hereditary), Black People in the U.S. began to suffer from anemia from these sickled red blood cells. This sickle cell anemia has, then, been peculiar, for these reasons, to Black People.

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